

Chapter One: The Dreadful Birthday

At 4 Privet Drive, a heated argument erupts within the Dursley household. Vernon Dursley, the uncle of Harry Potter, raises his voice in frustration as Harry's owl, Hedwig, makes a racket. Dudley Dursley, Vernon's spoiled and overweight son, demands more bacon, creating further chaos. In response, Harry mutters, "You've forgotten the magic word," triggering a frenzy within the family.

The narrator sheds light on the reason behind the commotion over the magic word. Harry Potter, a young wizard, is staying with the Dursleys for the summer after completing his first term at Hogwarts School of Witchcraft and Wizardry. Upon Harry's return from school, Uncle Vernon locked away all of his magical belongings — spellbooks, broomstick, wand, and cauldron — in a closet. The Dursleys, who are Muggles (non-magical people), were compelled to take in Harry after his parents were killed by Lord Voldemort, the most powerful wizard of their time. Although Harry survived Voldemort's curse, he bears a lightning-bolt-shaped scar on his forehead, hidden beneath his unruly dark hair and above his usually broken glasses. Due to his survival and the distinctive scar, Harry Potter gained fame in the wizarding world even before he could remember. Harry himself only discovered his magical abilities the previous summer when Hagrid, the gamekeeper at Hogwarts, arrived to whisk him away for his wizarding education at the age of eleven.

On the day our story begins, Harry is turning twelve, yet the Dursleys completely overlook his birthday. Their main concern is an upcoming dinner where Vernon, who sells drills, hopes to strike a lucrative business deal with a wealthy builder. During breakfast, Vernon instructs his wife, Petunia, and Dudley to rehearse their lines for the evening. Harry, on the other hand, is ordered to stay in his room and pretend not to exist.

Feeling downcast, Harry steps outside after breakfast, realizing that he hasn't received any messages from his best friends at Hogwarts, Ron Weasley and Hermione Granger. Suddenly, he spots a pair of enormous eyes peering at him from a nearby hedge. Before he can investigate further, Dudley waddles over and starts mocking Harry for not having any friends who remember his birthday. Ignoring his cousin, Harry continues to stare at the hedge until Dudley asks what he's doing. Harry casually suggests that he was contemplating setting the bush on fire. Panicked, Dudley cries out for his mother. Aunt Petunia promptly punishes Harry by assigning him chores around the house. Once Harry completes his tasks, she provides him with a meager dinner of bread and sends him to his room. As Harry enters his room, exhausted and ready to collapse onto his bed, he discovers someone else already seated there.

Chapter Two: Dobby's Caution

Seated on Harry's bed is a peculiar creature — a small being with bulging green eyes, bat-like ears, and ragged clothing made from a worn-out pillowcase. Harry recognizes it as the same entity he spotted in the bush earlier that day. The creature rises and introduces itself as Dobby, a house-elf. Harry kindly invites Dobby to sit. Overwhelmed by this gesture, Dobby bursts into

loud sobs, disrupting the voices of the dinner guests downstairs. Harry remarks that Dobby must not have encountered many kind wizards, prompting the house-elf to repeatedly bang his head against the window as self-punishment for speaking ill of his masters. He explains that he is bound to serve them until his death.

Dobby commends Harry for his fame, politeness, kindness, and humility. When Dobby mentions Voldemort, referring to him as "He-Who-Must-Not-Be-Named," Harry's denial fades. Dobby reveals that he wants to prevent Harry from returning to Hogwarts because danger awaits him there. Harry objects, but Dobby remains firm. Their conversation is interrupted when Vernon Dursley scolds Harry, forcing him to hide Dobby in the closet.

Harry becomes furious upon discovering that Dobby intercepted his mail from Ron and Hermione to discourage him from returning to school. Determined to go back, Harry refuses to listen. In a desperate attempt to stop him, Dobby enchants a violet pudding to levitate. The Dursleys are outraged, and matters worsen when an owl delivers a letter warning Harry that it is forbidden to use magic outside of school. The dinner party is ruined, and the business deal collapses. Harry is confined to his room with barred windows and fed through a small opening in the door. His situation feels hopeless until he wakes one night to find Ron Weasley outside his window in a flying car.

Chapter Three: The Weasley Home

Ron, along with his twin brothers Fred and George, has come to rescue Harry after receiving no replies to their letters. They remove the bars from Harry's window and retrieve his trunk. Uncle Vernon tries to stop them, but the Weasleys succeed, and they soar into the night sky in the enchanted car.

During the flight, Harry tells them about Dobby. The twins explain that house-elves serve wealthy wizard families. Harry suspects that Dobby belongs to Draco Malfoy. They also discuss Lucius Malfoy, Draco's father, who once followed Voldemort. The boys describe Mr. Weasley's job at the Ministry of Magic, where he handles enchanted Muggle objects.

At The Burrow, the Weasley home, Harry is welcomed warmly. Mrs. Weasley scolds her sons for taking the car but is relieved Harry is safe. Harry meets Ginny Weasley, who is shy around him, and Percy Weasley, who acts serious and studious. Though Ron feels embarrassed by his modest home, Harry finds it wonderful.

Chapter Four: A Visit to Flourish and Blotts

Harry enjoys his stay at The Burrow. When school supply lists arrive, the family prepares to visit Diagon Alley using Floo powder. Harry accidentally mispronounces his destination and ends up in Knockturn Alley, inside a dark shop. Hiding in a cabinet, he overhears Lucius Malfoy speaking with the shopkeeper about selling dark objects before a Ministry search. Draco complains about Harry and Hermione.

After the Malfoys leave, Hagrid finds Harry and brings him back to Diagon Alley, where the Weasleys and Hermione are worried. At Gringotts Bank, Mrs. Weasley withdraws their limited funds while Harry discreetly carries his own wealth. At Flourish and Blotts bookstore, Gilderoy Lockhart signs autographs and announces he will teach Defense Against the Dark Arts. Lockhart insists on taking a photograph with Harry. Lucius and Arthur Weasley argue, and a fight breaks out before they are separated.

Chapter Five: The Whomping Willow Incident

On their way to Hogwarts, Harry and Ron are blocked from entering platform nine and three-quarters. They decide to fly the enchanted Ford Anglia to school. The journey goes wrong when the car crashes into the Whomping Willow, a violent tree guarding the grounds. They barely escape and are caught by Professor Snape. Later, Professor Dumbledore and Professor McGonagall reprimand them but allow them to stay at school.

Chapter Six: The Charms of Gilderoy Lockhart

Ron receives a Howler from Mrs. Weasley during breakfast. Lockhart proves boastful and incompetent in class, releasing Cornish pixies he cannot control. Ron's broken wand continues malfunctioning.

Chapter Seven: Muggle-Borns and Whispers

During Quidditch practice, Draco Malfoy insults Hermione by calling her a "Mudblood," a slur against Muggle-borns. Ron attempts to curse him, but his wand backfires, causing him to vomit slugs. Later, Harry hears a mysterious voice whispering violent threats in the corridors.

Chapter Eight: The Deathday Celebration

On Halloween night, after attending Nearly-Headless Nick's Deathday party, Harry hears the voice again and discovers a message on the wall: "The Chamber of Secrets has been opened. Enemies of the Heir, beware." Mrs. Norris is found petrified.

Chapter Nine: The Enigma Unveiled

Dumbledore confirms that Mrs. Norris is petrified, not dead. Students learn about Salazar Slytherin and the legend of the Chamber of Secrets, said to contain a monster that can only be controlled by Slytherin's heir. Suspicion grows around Harry after he speaks Parseltongue during a Dueling Club session.

Chapter Ten: The Unyielding Bludger

During a Quidditch match, a rogue Bludger relentlessly attacks Harry. Despite catching the Snitch, he breaks his arm. Lockhart accidentally removes the bones while attempting to heal him. That night, Dobby admits to sealing the platform and bewitching the Bludger to protect Harry. Colin Creevey is later found petrified.

Chapter Eleven: The Dueling Club

At Lockhart's Dueling Club, Malfoy conjures a snake. Harry unknowingly speaks Parseltongue to control it, alarming the school. Later, Justin Finch-Fletchley and Nearly-Headless Nick are found petrified.

Chapter Twelve: The Polyjuice Potion

Harry, Ron, and Hermione brew Polyjuice Potion to question Malfoy. Harry and Ron successfully disguise themselves as Crabbe and Goyle, but Hermione accidentally transforms into a cat. They learn Malfoy is not the Heir of Slytherin.

Chapter Thirteen: The Very Secret Diary

Harry and Ron discover a diary belonging to T. M. Riddle, a student honored fifty years earlier. Hermione believes Riddle caught the previous culprit behind the Chamber's opening. The mystery deepens as the diary becomes central to uncovering the truth.